Index of NCI Studies (INS) Release Notes

Newest release listed first

INS Resources & Repositories Release (v3.5.0)

NOV 4, 2026

Summary

The "Resources & Repositories" Release of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is live at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This major release of the INS includes several updates to make NCI-supported research outputs and data resources available to the cancer research community. In addition to a full refresh of existing metadata references throughout the site (such as references to NCI-supported Programs and Datasets), this release introduces curated references to Data Repositories supporting cancer research in the INS Tools & Resources section. This release also includes a major update of the data support infrastructure to improve ongoing stability and security.

Data Snapshot

- 195 Programs
- 269 Resources
- 15,246 Datasets & Cohorts
- 2,997 Projects
- 16,704 Grants
- 66,930 Publications
- 82 Direct Download Data Files

Data in this release of INS were gathered, curated, or processed in September-October 2026 as part of version 2.5.0 of the data gathering pipeline.

Key Features

Data

- **Data Repository Index:** Added curated Data Repositories and descriptive metadata for display on the Tools & Resources page. Each repository is designated as "NCI", "NIH", or "External", which includes NIH Generalist Repository Ecosystem Initiative (GREI) Repositories. This list is not yet exhaustive; as with other aspects of INS, more will be added in the future.

- **Updated Resources:** Updated the resource curation to consolidate Tool Type values into more user-friendly and meaningful groups, which are available in the "Filter by Tool Type" left-hand filter on the Tools & Resources page. Added additional resource references, archived several that are no longer supported, and moved several to the Programs or Datasets sections of INS.
- **New Dataset Source:** Added 13 publicly available datasets from the Division of Cancer Treatment and Diagnosis (DCTD)
- **Updated Programs and Research Outputs:** Updated the curated list of NCI Programs, links, and funding identifiers, which are used to gather up-to-date metadata for NCI-supported Projects, Grants, Publications, GEO Datasets, and SRA Datasets
- **Updated Datasets:** Refreshed curations and auto-gathered metadata for datasets and cohorts from several sources: dbGaP (including CRDC/GDC studies), DCEG Cohorts, and the NCCR Data Platform

Interface

- Added Resource count to the Home page bar chart display
- Renamed "Data Repository" label for Datasets to "Data Resource" for all fields and filters
- Standardized display of "Principal Investigators" across several instances throughout the INS
- Updated About page to include changes to Resources and data gathering pipeline
- Improved handling of special characters during metadata gathering to retain them for display
- Improved Home page load time with optimized image sizes
- Minor polish and design improvements

Infrastructure

- Completed major migration of the INS data loading pipeline execution infrastructure to improve security posture and meet NCI security requirements (Jenkins to Prefect)
- Updated site metadata information to improve search engine optimization (SEO)
- Improved stability and security with a proactive audit and removal of unused code dependencies
- Improved security and infrastructure support with ongoing vulnerability mitigation and prevention
- Minor bugfixes and stability improvements

End of Release Notes for the INS v3.5.0.

Release Notes for earlier updates are listed below for reference. Minor technical releases without user-facing changes are not listed. Links, descriptions, and counts in earlier release notes may be outdated, nonfunctional, or no longer relevant.

INS July 2026 Resource Update (v3.4.1)

JULY 9, 2026

Summary

The "INS July 2026 Resource Update" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This update builds upon the previous, major INS Resources Release (v3.4.0) to improve available resource information for the cancer research community. In addition to routine curation updates, all resources were reviewed for current, accurate links and references, and several were consolidated or retired to reflect the evolving research landscape. This release also includes improvements to search and highlight behavior on the Resource Search page, as well as minor updates to the interface. Finally, this update includes critical support for security and stability infrastructures.

Data Snapshot

- 195 Programs
- 276 Resources
- 14,035 Datasets & Cohorts
- 3,036 Projects
- 15,790 Grants
- 64,174 Publications
- 82 Direct Download Data Files

Data in this release of INS were gathered, curated, or processed in June 2026 as part of version 2.4.1 of the data gathering pipeline. Only Resources were updated in this release; Programs, Datasets, etc., all remain unchanged and will be updated in the future.

End of Release Notes for the INS v3.4.1.

Release Notes for earlier updates are listed below for reference. Minor technical releases without user-facing changes are not listed. Links, descriptions, and counts in earlier release notes may be outdated, nonfunctional, or no longer relevant.

INS Resources Release (v3.4.0)

JUNE 11, 2026

Summary

The “INS Resources Release” of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This major update introduces a new **Resources** section containing NCI-supported tools and resources available to the cancer research community. As a complement to the existing **Programs** and **Datasets** sections of the INS, the Resources section includes a searchable index of resources with metadata standardized for findability. Each resource has a link to an external reference as well as a dedicated **Resource Detail** page with additional information.

This initial release includes 284 resources consolidated from the **NCI Resources for Researchers (R4R)** and **NCI Data Catalog**. As with other aspects of the INS, the Resources section is expected to expand in both scale and scope as more resources are curated and additional resources lists are included in the future.

Data Snapshot

- 195 Programs
- 284 Resources
- 14,035 Datasets & Cohorts
- 3,036 Projects
- 15,790 Grants
- 64,174 Publications
- 82 Direct Download Data Files

Data in this release of INS were gathered, curated, or processed in May 2026 as part of version 2.4.0 of the data gathering pipeline. Only Resources were updated in this release; Programs, Datasets, etc., all remain unchanged and will be updated in the future.

Key Features

Data

- **New Type**: A new **Resources** record type is introduced into the INS data model with standardized metadata describing tools and resources
- **New Source**: Added 268 resources pulled from the **NCI Resources for Researchers (R4R)**. Metadata for each resource was transformed and standardized to use the INS data model
- **New Source:** Added 16 additional resources pulled from the **NCI Data Catalog**. These 16 represent unique resources not already included in the R4R batch.

Interface

- Added a new **Explore Tools & Resources** page, with search, filter, and card preview features modeled after the existing Explore Datasets & Cohorts
- Added a new **Resource Detail** page with additional display of standardized metadata for each resource modeled after the existing Dataset Detail page
- Added dynamic disabling of the Dataset Search button when too few characters are input into the search bar
- Minor polish and updates to design

Infrastructure

- Added architecture to support the new Resources data node
- Improved security and infrastructure support with ongoing vulnerability mitigation and prevention

End of Release Notes for the INS v3.4.0.

Release Notes for earlier updates are listed below for reference. Minor technical releases without user-facing changes are not listed. Links, descriptions, and counts in earlier release notes may be outdated, nonfunctional, or no longer relevant.

INS Dataset Expansion Release (v3.3.0)

APRIL 2, 2026

Summary

The "INS Dataset Expansion Release" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This major data-focused release significantly expands the collection of datasets and cohorts available through the INS by adding several new NCI-supported data sources and refreshing existing records across the platform. This release nearly doubles the total number of datasets and cohorts available in INS from 7,889 to 14,035, while also improving dataset discovery through search, accessibility, and navigation updates.

New additions include datasets from the **NCBI Sequence Read Archive (SRA)**, the **Division of Cancer Epidemiology & Genetics (DCEG)**, the Childhood Cancer Data Initiative (CCDI) **National Childhood Cancer Registry (NCCR) Data Platform**, and a subset of datasets associated with the **Cancer Research Data Commons (CRDC)** and **NCI Genomic Data Commons (GDC)**.

Data Snapshot

- 195 Programs
- 14,035 Datasets & Cohorts
- 3,036 Projects
- 15,790 Grants
- 64,174 Publications
- 82 Direct Download Data Files

Data in this release of INS were gathered, curated, or processed in February and March 2026 as part of version 2.3.0 of the data gathering pipeline.

Key Features

Data

- **New Source**: Added 4,945 datasets from the **NCBI's Sequence Read Archive (SRA)** associated with NCI-funded projects within INS. This includes a new automated data pipeline to leverage existing APIs to pull SRA dataset information and then format it to fit the INS data model.
- **New Source**: Added 15 cohorts curated from **Division of Cancer Epidemiology & Genetics (DCEG)** publicly available data
- **New Source**: Added 7 cancer surveillance and linked real-world data sources submitted from the Childhood Cancer Data Initiative (CCDI) **National Childhood Cancer Registry (NCCR) Data Platform**

- **New Source**: Added 160 datasets pulled from the **Cancer Research Data Commons (CRDC)** and the **NCI Genomic Data Commons (GDC)**. These represent the subset of studies registered with dbGaP that use the CRDC and/or GDC as a Data Storage and Distribution Platform.
- Updated all existing NCI-supported Programs (29 new) and their associated Grants (2,331 new), Projects (370 new), Publications (8,171 new), and Gene Expression Omnibus (GEO) datasets (924 new)
- Updated all existing Database of Genotypes and Phenotypes (dbGaP) datasets (95 new)
- Updated all datasets from the Cancer Epidemiology and Descriptive Cohort Database (CEDCD) and Cancer Target Discovery and Development (CTD^2) Network (Counts unchanged; minor metadata improvements)

Interface

- Added a main menu link to the NCI Data Sharing Hub to improve access to NCI Office of Data Sharing resources for the cancer research community
- Added a government warning banner to identify the site as an official government resource and provide users with standard guidance about federal websites
- Implemented "Section 508" updates across the site to improve accessibility and support consistent experience for users with assistive technologies
- Improved dataset search results and highlighting consistency to support dataset findability
- Added Study Type to the Dataset card view summary and expanded searchable dataset fields to include Institute, Experimental Approaches, and Data Storage and Distribution Platform, giving users more ways to identify relevant datasets
- Updated the main menu navigation when using a mobile or tablet device to improve accessibility

Infrastructure

- Applied infrastructure and dependency updates to strengthen the overall security posture of the platform and support ongoing system maintenance.
- Refactored and standardized the infrastructure deployment process using the Amazon Web Services Cloud Development Toolkit (AWS CDK), improving consistency and maintainability across environments
- Generated stable Universally Unique Identifiers (UUIDs) for all datasets and then restructured pages to use UUIDs as the key identifier
- Enhanced the underlying system architecture to support display and CSV export of more than 10,000 datasets, improving scalability as the platform continues to grow

End of Release Notes for the INS v3.3.0.

Release Notes for earlier updates are listed below for reference. Minor technical releases without user-facing changes are not listed. Links, descriptions, and counts in earlier release notes may be outdated, nonfunctional, or no longer relevant.

INS Direct Download Data Release (v3.2.0)

DEC 18, 2025

Summary

The "INS Direct Download Data Release" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This major release includes support for direct download of open-access data packages from certain datasets, rather than redirecting to an external site. The first datasets with direct downloads available are from the **Cancer Target Discovery and Development (CTD²) Network**, now hosted by the INS. This functionality will allow the INS to support additional data resource types in the future and continue to make NCI data more Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable (FAIR).

Data Snapshot

- 166 Programs
- 7,889 Datasets & Cohorts
- 2,666 Projects
- 13,549 Grants
- 56,003 Publications
- 82 Direct Download Data Files

Data in this release of INS were gathered, curated, or processed in November 2025 as part of version 2.2.0 of the data gathering pipeline.

Key Features

Data

- Curated and integrated study details for 98 datasets from the CTD² Network
- Added feature to directly download open-access data files for supported datasets, starting with 82 study-specific data packages for the CTD² Network
- Updated dbGaP studies with improved, curated Primary Disease categorization for improved accuracy and filtering

Interface

- Improved search and sort behaviors on the Explore Datasets & Cohorts page, including better handling of special characters and multi-word searches

- Improved filters on the Explore Datasets & Cohorts page to dynamically update available selections and counts in response to active search and filters
- Added dynamic display of fields in the Explore Datasets & Cohorts page card view to avoid display of blank or irrelevant fields not used by all dataset resources
- Added tooltip with detailed search instructions and search behavior description based on user feedback
- Implemented redesigned, more flexible Dataset Detail page to better handle datasets from various resources with different use cases
- Added dynamic display of fields and sections on the Dataset Detail page to prevent display of blank or irrelevant fields not used by all dataset resources
- Updated site header and footer to meet NCI branding and digital standards

Infrastructure

- Implemented new architecture to allow for fast, secure user download of open-access dataset files
- Updated data model to accommodate new resources and for flexible connections between datasets and downloadable files, which will allow for scalable future expansion
- Updated software and deployment strategies to improve security and performance

[End of Release Notes for the INS v3.2.0. Release Notes for earlier updates are listed below for reference. Links, descriptions, and counts in earlier release notes may be outdated, nonfunctional, or no longer relevant.]

INS Intramural & Datasets Release (v3.1.0)

JUNE 10, 2025

Summary

The "INS Intramural & Datasets Release" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This major release brings together NCI-supported intramural projects and their research outputs into the Index of NCI Studies (INS) alongside existing extramural projects. The update significantly expands the collection of NCI-supported datasets to include new source repositories: the Gene Expression Omnibus (GEO) and Cancer Epidemiology Descriptive Cohort Database (CEDCD), while broadening the existing curation of dbGaP studies.

This release nearly doubles the total number of records in INS—from approximately 44,000 to over 80,000.

Looking ahead, the INS will continue expanding to additional data resources to enhance the discoverability of NCI-supported data and research outputs.

Key Features

Data

- Added 6,751 datasets from the NCBI Gene Expression Omnibus (GEO) associated with NCI-supported projects within the INS
- Added 655 intramural projects from the NCI Center for Cancer Research (CCR) along with their downstream research outputs
- Added 69 intramural projects from the NCI Division of Cancer Epidemiology & Genetics (DCEG) along with their downstream research outputs
- Added 70 cohort studies from the NCI Cancer Epidemiology Descriptive Cohort Database (CEDCD)
- Added 102 new NCI-supported studies registered with the NCBI Database of Genotypes and Phenotypes (dbGaP); refreshed 871 existing study records

Interface

- Introduced mouseover tooltips providing definitions for all fields on the Dataset Details page
- Added redirect suggestions on Documentation Searches that yield no results
- Enhanced the Project and Program Details pages with improved styling and Section 508 Compliance (accessibility)
- Renamed the "Explore Datasets" page to "Explore Datasets & Cohorts" to better describe CEDCD cohort integration
- Introduced new checkbox filter to the Explore Datasets page for filtering by specific source repositories (CEDCD, dbGaP, and GEO)

- Added mobile responsive designs for the Home and About pages with alert for optimal screen size
- Added US Government banner to header
- Updated descriptive content in the About page, Glossary, and Release Notes
- Resolved minor typographical errors and other bugs

Infrastructure

- Updated data model to accommodate multiple dataset source repositories
- Updated software packages for environment security maintenance

Data Summary

This release includes information for:

- 166 Programs
- 7,794 Datasets & Cohorts
- 2,666 Projects
- 13,549 Grants
- 56,003 Publications

Data in this release of INS were gathered, curated, or processed in May 2025 using version 2.1.0 of the data gathering pipeline.

[End of Release Notes for the INS v3.1.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Datasets Release (v3.0.0)

NOV 26, 2024

Summary

The “INS Datasets Release” of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov!

This major update adds new data and features focusing on datasets generated through NCI-supported research. Initially, this includes references to NCI-supported studies registered with the NCBI dbGaP, though the INS will expand to other dataset resources in the future.

The NCI-supported Programs, Projects, Grants, and Publications have also been improved and expanded since the last release, with the INS now holding more than double the number of records for each.

KEY FEATURES

- Added 871 NCI-supported studies registered with the NCBI Database of Genotypes and Phenotypes (dbGaP) to the INS as the first datasets
    - Various dbGaP metadata sources were incorporated into the automated INS data gathering pipeline to pull dataset information
    - The automated dataset results were further curated for accuracy and completeness
- Added a new Explore Datasets page to allow users to search, browse, and preview dataset information
    - Card-view presentations of each dataset include basic descriptive information along with links to the INS Dataset Details page and directly to the external source (i.e. dbGaP study page)
    - Facet filters allow selection of specific Primary Diseases of interest. Results will include only datasets focused on the filter selections
    - Search bar allows for free text search that will access all text-based dataset fields and return only matching results
    - Search highlights will identify the matching term(s) in each resulting dataset
    - Export button will download a CSV with all the metadata for each dataset in the current results
- Added a new Dataset Details page to allow users to view all detailed information captured by the INS for each specific dataset
    - Includes all information displayed on the Explore Page card view in addition to more detailed information, such as Principal Investigator(s), Funding Source(s), Limitations for Reuse, and related keyword terms
    - External links to the NCBI PubMed are provided for any relevant publications cited by the dataset
- Improved the Program Details page to present a descriptive display and external link to the program website when no research outputs are currently captured by the INS for that program
- Updated the Home Page links and graphics to integrate the datasets pages and information

- Updated the About Page to include dataset information to both the text narrative and to the data flow diagram
- Updated preview text within the header Documentation Search bar for clarity
- Added new automation practices for faster, more scalable QA testing of data
- Upgraded infrastructure and deployment pipelines to improve stability and security
- Updated software packages and resolved various security issues

Data Details

This release includes information for:

- 163 Programs
- 871 Datasets
- 1,899 Projects
- 6,376 Grants
- 35,339 Publications

Program-derived data in this release of INS were gathered on September 20, 2024, using version 2.0.0 of the data gathering pipeline. Dataset data were gathered and curated in September-October 2024.

[End of Release Notes for the INS v3.0.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Tooltips Release (v2.2.0)

JUNE 28, 2024

Summary

The “INS Tooltips Release” of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov! This lightweight update brings interactive tooltips to help users better understand terms used throughout the site. This release also carries several technical improvements that will aid future development.

KEY FEATURES

- Added interactive definition tooltips to most column headers across all tabs of the Explore Page
- Expanded the “Disclaimer Banner” to all pages of the site rather than only the Home Page
- Changed the fixed header to a floating header, giving users more display space and improving compatibility with other header features
- Implemented Adobe Analytics for all pages
- Improved detail of software version display in site footer
- Minor bugfixes for sorting and table display

The underlying data remains unchanged in this release.

[End of Release Notes for the INS v2.2.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Detail Pages Release (v2.1.0)

MAY 9, 2024

Summary

The "INS Detail Pages Release" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov! This release builds upon the recent "Program Redesign" and reintroduces two page views to the site: the **Program Details Page** and **Project Details Page**. Each presents a focused view of additional details including a filtered view of the Explore Page tables relevant to the Program or Project. Every program and project within INS can now be better explored using these pages.

Example Pages

Program Details: Fusion OncoProteins in Childhood Cancers (FusOnc2)

Project Details: Defining and targeting the molecular vulnerabilities of the PAX3-FOXO1 protein in rhabdomyosarcoma (U54CA231630)

KEY FEATURES

- Implemented Program Details and Project Details Pages
- Added links to Program Details and Project Details Pages throughout the Explore page tables
- Added a new Program Cancer Type checkbox filter to the Explore Page
- Restructured data model and data gathering to separate Program Cancer Type(s) from Focus Area(s)
- Updated all INS data (programs, projects, grants, publications)
- Improved user navigation and sorting in tables
- Improved formatting of special characters within data and CSV downloads
- Improved data validation protocol for more efficient QA testing
- Upgraded infrastructure and deployment pipelines to improve stability and security

Data Details

This release includes information for:

- 83 Programs
- 757 Projects
- 3,065 Grants
- 22,199 Publications

Data in this release of INS were gathered on April 26, 2024, using v1.1.0 of the data gathering pipeline.

INS Program Redesign (v2.0.0)

APRIL 4, 2024

Summary

The “INS Program Redesign” of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov! This release represents a major overhaul of the data, design, and function of the site in response to feedback gathered from initial releases.

The INS is now expanded to include 83 programs curated by the NCI’s Office of Data Sharing. These programs act as the input into a redesigned, automated data gathering process that utilizes public resources from NIH RePORTER, NIH iCite, and NCBI PubMed to gather projects, grants, and publications associated with each program. Features of the site have been redesigned to center on the new data design.

KEY FEATURES

Overview

- Expanded scope of NCI program curation from 2 initial programs to 83
- Redesigned automated data gathering process to find associated projects, grants, and publications for each program using stable, publicly available APIs
- Redesigned data model to accommodate new fields and connections within gathered data
- Redesigned Explore Page with all new tables, plots, and search/filter capabilities
- Removed obsolete Programs page and navigation button. Programs are now integrated within the Explore Page
- Removed Program Detail and Project Detail Pages. These will be considered for future releases
- Removed datasets, clinical trials, and patents data types. These will be considered for future releases
- Updated Home Page text and stat bar graphic
- Updated About Page documentation and design
- Updated Glossary to address new terms and changes to existing terms
- Upgraded frontend framework to support additional visualizations (Bento 4.0)
- Upgraded infrastructure and deployment pipelines to improve stability and security

Data Details

This release includes information for:

- 83 Programs

- 757 Projects
- 3,047 Grants
- 21,898 Publications

Data in this release of INS were gathered on March 13, 2024, using v1.0.0 of the data gathering pipeline.

[End of Release Notes for the INS v2.0.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Minor Security Release (v1.3.0)

AUG 31, 2023

Summary

The Minor Security Release of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov. The primary focus of this release is to perform maintenance and security updates. Though important, these types of updates are generally not visible to a visitor to the site. However, we have also included updated graphics and animations on the Home Page along with various bugfixes and visual polish throughout the site.

The underlying data remains unchanged in this release.

Home page

- Added mouseover rotation animation to the INS hero image
- Improved responsive design to allow the hero image to better fit a wider range of screen sizes

General updates

- Updated the INS backend to the Bento Framework v4.10
- Updated backend packages to improve security
- Employed Search Engine Optimization strategy to help users find the site
- Improved formatting of CSV downloads and download buttons
- Improved browser tab behavior for external links in global footer

[End of Release Notes for the INS v1.3.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Core Project Remodel (v1.2.0)

MAY 4, 2023

Summary

The "Core Project Remodel" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov. The primary focus of this release is to reorganize the data and display of the INS to center around (core) projects rather than grants, which addresses one of the major improvements identified in the initial release.

As before, we are only including outputs from projects funded at least in part by **extramural grants** associated with the **Moonshot** and **Childhood Cancer Data Initiative (CCDI).** The task of identifying and defining programs remains a challenge to be addressed in future releases of the INS.

KEY FEATURES

Overview

- Redesigned data architecture to organize grants (formerly known as projects within the INS) into groups of grants. Those groups are now called projects and become the focal point of the INS
    - Redesigned the Project Details Page to focus on one project with all associated grants and outputs displayed. Project descriptions are pulled from the most recently awarded grant, except for the Award Amount Total fields, which display summed values from all associated grants.
    - Added Project Details Page links to all tabs of the Explore Page to quickly find all information for a project from any grant or output of that project
    - Updated Explore Page filters, Programs Page, Program Details Page, and Global Search to reflect the new roles of projects and grants
    - Updated documentation pages (About, Glossary, Release Notes)
- Added animation and updated the Stats Bar Graph image on the Home Page
- Improved data gathering date filters to reduce false positive associations
- Added 3 new manually curated CCDI P30 supplement datasets and projects

Data Details

This release includes the following data totals:

- 2 Programs
- 350 Projects
- 1,211 Grants
- 4,748 Publications

- 1,388 Datasets
- 349 Clinical Trials
- 117 Patents

New in this release of INS are several datasets shared due to CCDI P30 grant supplements to the following organizations:

- Memorial Sloan-Kettering Cancer Center (MSKCC): phs003111.v1.p1 | 3P30CA008748-54S3
    - Note: this is an additional dataset shared due to a CCDI P30 grant supplement already associated with another dataset in the INS (phs002620.v1.p1)
- University of Kansas Medical Center: phs002529.v1.p1 | 3P30CA168524-09S3
- University of Southern California: phs002518.v1.p1 | 3P30CA014089-45S6

Note that due to the indirect nature of grant supplements, these 3 projects and their outputs were gathered and added to the INS through manual curation rather than the standard automated process.

This release includes a new batch of data gathered using the automated processes. It includes improvements in the preprocessing pipeline to filter out any outputs published before the earliest associated grant was awarded. This helps to limit false positive associations.

Projects, grants, publications, datasets, and clinical trials included in this release were gathered on April 4, 2023. Due to instability in the external source from which we gather Patents (USPTO API) in April, patents included in this release were gathered on March 2, 2023.

[End of Release Notes for the INS v1.2.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Minor Release (v1.1.0)

JAN 5, 2023

Summary

The latest "Minor Release" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov. The primary focus of this release is to introduce several key features and fixes identified in the initial release.

As before, we are only including outputs from **extramural grants** funded through the **Moonshot** and **Childhood Cancer Data Initiative (CCDI).** We intend to address the CCDI data complications mentioned in the site disclaimer in future releases.

KEY FEATURES

Overview

- Added 4 manually curated CCDI P30 supplement datasets
- Added buttons for users to download tables as CSV files for easier ad hoc analyses
- Added INS Glossary and INS Release Notes PDFs to the main navigation menu bar
- Added "Publication Date" column to Publications tables
- Removed "NIH Percentile" column from Publications tables
- Redesigned architecture of Project Detail and Program Detail pages to improve performance and table navigation
- Many small UI improvements and bugfixes

Data Details

This release includes the following data totals:

- 2 Programs
- 1,041 Projects
- 4,098 Publications
- 1,119 Datasets
- 207 Clinical Trials
- 117 Patents

New in this release of INS are several datasets shared due to CCDI P30 grant supplement projects to the following organizations:

- Memorial Sloan-Kettering Cancer Center (MSKCC): 3P30CA008748-54S3
- Oregon Health & Science University (OHSU): 3P30CA069533-22S5
- Baylor College of Medicine: 3P30CA125123-14S6
- University of California, San Francisco (UCSF): 3P30CA082103-21S9

Note that due to the indirect nature of grant supplements, these 4 projects and their outputs were gathered and added to the INS through manual curation rather than the standard automated process.

The data in this release uses the same automated data gathering output as previous releases of INS (09/26/2022 for Projects, Publications, and Patents; 05/26/2022 for Datasets and Clinical Trials) but improves the curation to remove duplicates and other minor display issues. As mentioned above, it also includes 4 manually curated CCDI projects and their datasets.

[End of Release Notes for the INS v1.1.0. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Disclaimer Release (v1.0.1)

NOV 18, 2022

Summary

The latest "Disclaimer Release" of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) is available now at studycatalog.cancer.gov. The primary focus of this small release is to add additional information about challenges faced and known limitations of the initial phase of the INS.

Building connections between NCI programs, grants, and outputs is a complex task usually addressed through manual curation by portfolio analysis experts. As we work to automate the process and share this resource with the public, we would like to inform you of the known limitations within the data gathering process and information displayed by the INS. We are working on improving data gathering process and will periodically release updates which allows us to iteratively improve the INS site.

Note that the underlying data remains unchanged in this release.

Home page

- Added disclaimer banner to the header
- Changed title text and subtext to highlight known limitations

About page

- Added "Gathering Research Outputs: A Continuous Challenge" section to describe known limitations in detail

General improvements

- Improved neo4j queries on Project Detail pages to avoid potential memory overload errors

[End of Release Notes for the INS v1.0.1. Release Notes for earlier updates listed below.]

INS Initial Release (v1.0.0)
OCT 11, 2022

Summary

The National Cancer Institute (NCI) is pleased to announce the release of the Index of NCI Studies (INS) at studycatalog.cancer.gov.

The INS is a new website that gathers and displays publicly available information about research outputs from NCI-funded programs. The goal of the INS is to encourage an environment of FAIR (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, Reusable) data sharing and to reinforce the NCI's commitment to transparency and accountability as the nation's leader in cancer research.

The intent of the **initial phase** of the INS is to solicit feedback for further expansion of this tool, which is limited in both scope and scale by design. The current site focuses on gathering data outputs associated with **extramural grants** from two key NCI programs: the **Cancer Moonshot** and the **Childhood Cancer Data Initiative** (CCDI).

KEY FEATURES

Overview

This release includes the following pages and features:

- Home page
- Explore page
    - 1,037 Projects
    - 4,121 Publications
    - 1,121 Shared Datasets
    - 207 Clinical Trials
    - 117 Patents
- Programs page
    - 2 Programs
- About page
- Project Detail page
- Program Detail page
- Global Search Bar & Results page

Home page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/home

The Home page is the intended landing page for users viewing the site. It provides introductory information about the INS and links to other pages. Users can navigate to the Home page with a link in the main navigation bar.

Explore page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/explore

The Explore page provides comprehensive lists of projects and research outputs in the site and is the primary page for browsing projects and research outputs. Users can navigate to the Explore page with a link in the main navigation bar. The tables contain 5 tabs with tables grouped by project or research output type:

- Projects
- Publications
- Datasets
- Clinical Trials
- Patents

Research outputs generally have an external link to allow users to navigate to the source output directly. Projects show an internal link that take a user to the Projects view page.

The lists of projects and research outputs can be dynamically filtered by several project attributes listed below. Donut charts provide basic project metrics and are updated as filters are applied.

- PROGRAM
- DIVISION/OFFICE/CENTER (DOC)
- FISCAL YEAR
- AWARD AMOUNT

Programs page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/programs

The Programs page lists the programs currently included within the INS, along with links and basic metrics associated with each. Each row contains both an external link to a program's website and an internal link to the INS Program Detail page for that program. Currently, this page shows only the two programs included in

the initial release of the INS: Moonshot and CCDI. Users can navigate to the Programs page with a link in the main navigation bar.

About page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/about

The About page gives an overview of the INS project, data gathering process, and site functionality. Users can navigate to the About page with a link in the main navigation bar.

Project Detail page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/project/1U01CA217885-01 (example)

The Project Detail page gives detailed information concerning a specific project, categorized into sections for Basic Info, PI and Organization, and Award information. In addition, the Project Detail page contains tables listing research outputs associated with the parent project. Tables for different types of research outputs can be accessed by clicking on the corresponding tab (Publications, GEOS, SRAs, dbGaPs, Clinical Trials, or Patents). The tables accessible within this page are a subset of the data accessible via the Explore page.

Program Detail page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/program/Moonshot (example)

The Program Detail page gives detailed information concerning a specific program. This includes sections for basic descriptive information, external links, and donut charts of selected metrics. In addition, the Program Detail page contains a table of all associated projects. The table accessible within this page is a subset of the data accessible via the Explore page.

Global Search Bar & Results page

https://studycatalog.cancer.gov/#/search/

The Global Search Bar accepts searches of Project details and About page contents and returns the relevant Project Detail page or About page section via the Results page. The search function currently only accepts exact prefix matches. For example, searching for project ID “**1**U01CA217885-01” will successfully return the project, but “U01CA217885-01” will not. Improving this search functionality will be a priority for future releases.